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In this issue:

1. From the Editor's desk
2. Wisdom from Shiva's Rattle drum
3. Pratyabhijna made easy
4. Basics of the Doctrine of Pratyabhijna
5. Wisdom from Shiva's Rattle Drum
6. Pics and poems

From the Editor's desk

A Revival of metaphysical pessimism

Metaphysical Pessimism is the only ideology to resolve the strategy of perpetuated miseries. As an ancient adage goes, for a wise man even pleasure is painful. A hedonistic bent has its omissions and commissions as well as justification of “the pursuit of happiness”, but the stoic moderator has just one joy of just punctuating two consequent sorrows so there is no such thing as absolute happiness, it's temporal, transient and ephemeral. The difference is like the one between a person who would rather endure thirst but not head for the mirage water which just doesn't exist, and the one who is lured by his own optical aberration. Confucius said you are never too happy when you think you are too happy. The absolute happiness as the Buddhism pessimism goes is merely a temporal illusory recess within the shell of perpetual misery. Schopenhauer, the most prominent exponent of pessimism in the west who founded his theorem on the concept of the empty nest of existence, has certainly not plagiarised the Buddha but what he propounded has emanated from a centre deep within the human psyche, where every man is closer to Buddha, or let us say the essential Buddha nature. Indian school of syllogism defines sorrow and happiness in terms of personal subjective experience. An unfavourable stimulus is a *dukha* and favourable one is *sukha*. But the issue of authenticity remains indecisive as an individual's experience cannot be considered as free from aberrations. The is where metaphysical thought needs to intervene. Men of enlightenment, the soothsayers have had an intuitive insight into the miserable plight of human destiny and fate. This has also necessitated ancient words of wisdom which were rapidly losing their contemporary ness and passing into oblivion for getting obsolete, have to be recapitulated. Some adaptations from the cantos of the Gita for example, Corona can infect your lungs and destroy your body but not the self, or Wordsworth for instance, “Dust you art into dust you return was not spoken of the soul”. The axiom of prenatal and post mortem continuity of the soul to forebear the fruition of karmas - good or bad can be soothing to the ailing minds of humankind who is having to put up with tremendous replication of this diabolical virus. For the infected and ailing bodies, men of science have strived strenuously and have come out with an effective immunity enhancing vaccine. Meanwhile this vicious virus has undergone genetic changes and has become more infectious by mutating . Like all other preceding pandemics this one too with its future variants will subside and presumably pass into oblivion . But suffering, as the inevitable destiny of humankind is going to be relevant for ever. Buddha's dictum which asserts दुःखं as the eternal truth will remain consistent . सुखेन तदनन्तरित्वात् । The pain Buddha has postulated as eternal is neither mediated nor punctuated and not even alloyed by *sukha* or pleasure .

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PRATYABHIJNA HRIDAYAM made easy

(Sutra 3)

tannana anurupa grahya grahak bhedat

(Translation) That universal phenomena is multifarious, owing to the distinction of objective and subjective awareness.

(Exposition)

The Vishwam or Universal Phenomena consisting of 36 elements has multifarious proportions of subjective and objective awareness pairs within itself. The divergence accounts for the multiplicity that the author explains in this sutra

Tat -

Refers to Vishwam

Nanatvam - (Manifold)

The multiplicity in this context is special owing to various pairs of experience and experiencer. The sole experience being Parameshwar who acquires various forms according to the proportions of objectivity and subjectivity.

Anurupa -

Anurupa specifies *Nanatvam*. It is in accordance with the objective and subjective awareness.

(Mutual gradation of objective and subjective situations)

In the state of *Sada Shiva*, little divergence is seen and this divergence is concealed in his subjective awareness. Same is the case with *Mantra Maheswaras* who are presided over by Sada Shiva which are thus situated by the will of Parameswara. In their case the experience of I-ness is dominating and the experience of This-ness is incipient (a-sphuta)

From Ishwara's stand point both objective and subjective awareness are equal so the form of the phenomenon is that of the group of *Mantreshwara*.

In the realm of vidya, "mantras" are presided over by Lord Ananda and are divided into various branches – are the Pramatas. The object is a universal phenomena which is also multiple like the "mantras".

Above Maya tatva the *Vijnanakalas* which are devoid of alldoerships and are of the nature of pure knowledge are the *pramata-prameya* being similar entities called *sakala* and *pralayakala* which are known in a-priori states of the pramatas of void (*shunya pramata*).

This was about tatvas above Maya. In Maya, the "prameya" is in accordance to *Pralaykevalins* (somewhat praleen or Pralaya).

Sakalas which lie to upto earth or *prithvi* which are absolutely multifarious, the prameyas are also accordingly multifarious).

For the transcendental Shiv Bhattaraka who is all prakasha - the prameya is prakasha only that is there is no objectivity.

Parashiva is Transcendental. Universal phenomena from Shiva to prithvi projects as not different from "prakasha". Essentially there is no such object or subject thing as Lord Paramshiv alone manifests as myriad multiplicity - this has tried to depict the objects as the universal phenomena which is also multiple like the "mantras".

No. Tattva The Presiding Deity The Experiencer Corresponding field of experience

1 Shiva Shiva Shiva Pramata All existence is mere Prakasha or Shiva

2 Sadashiva- Iccha or Will is predominant Sadashiva Bhattaraka Mantra Maheshwara. The experience of I or Shiva is clear but there is also a hazy experience of the Universe Indistinct experience of the universe, not yet distinct from Self experience

3 Ishwar Tattva- Jnana is predominant Ishwara Bhattaraka Mantreshwara who like Ishwara has a distinct experience of both "I" and the Universe but universe appears as only an aspect of Self Experience of Self and the universe as both distinct and equally matched but universe as an aspect of self

4 Suddhavidya Tattva- Kriya or Action is predominant Ananta Bhattaraka Mantra who has the experience of both 'I' and the universe as separate but the universe as closely related to Self Experience of difference from every thing and yet everything appearing as closely related to the Self

5 Mayaordhava Tattva Vijnanakala- Full of knowledge but devoid of agency. Free from Mayiya mala and Karma mala but is still subject to Anava mala All the Pralayakalas and Sakalas

6 Maya Tattva Pralayakala or Pralayakevali or Sunya Pramata. Free from Karma mala but is subject to Anava and Mayiya mala Mere void

7 The remaining Tattvas upto the Prathvi Sakala- From the Devas upto the plant and minerals. Subject to all the three malas Experiencing all things as different from each other and also from the Self

Grahya – Grahak -

The proportions of objective and subjective awareness.

Grahya is observed, the object of experience – objective

Grahak is the observer, one who experiences – subjective

Shuddhvidya is the buffer state. When it is divergent it expands as Maya, Kala, Raga, Niyati, Vidya etc., upto Prithvi. When it is convergent it supersedes objectivity and rises to Sadashiva, Ishwara etc.

Shuddhvidya downwards *Grahya* part is more, and upwards *Grahak* part predominates.

Shiva is the sole *grahak* of the entire *grahi* phenomena. The relative notion of *Graha* and *Grahak* accounts for the variation within the *Vishwa* or the universal phenomena comprising of 36 elements. Thus the differentiation in the proportion of objective and subjective experience results into manifold existence.

Questions

- Q1. What is meant by the term Vishwam?
- Q2. What accounts for the multiplicity?
- Q3. Define Grahya and Grahak.
- Q4. What is Grahya and Grahak in the tattvas starting from Sadashiva to Prithvi?
- Q5. Define a) Matreshwara b) Mantra c) Vijnanakala d) Pralayakala e) Sakala
- Q6. Shiva alone springs forth in the form of various gradations of Grahya and Grahak. Explain.

3. Thoughts on the doctrine of pratyabhijna

(English rendering of an article read by Dr Shivshankaramishra at the YTA colloquium)

The minister Shaivism prevalent in the valley of Kashmir, is threefold and known as *trika*, *spanda*, and *pratyabhijna*, the doctrine of *trika* discusses the triad of nara, Shiva and Shakti. Elsewhere this school of thought mainly enunciates the elementary constituents (तत्त्व) in the form of *pashu*, *padha* and *pati* or the lord, the bound and the bondage. This doctrine is known by various other names too e.g. Kashmir Shaiva, pratyabhijna, trik, spanda, tryambaka, shad ardh shastra, sad ardh krama Vijnanam etc. Owing to its pertinence to the power of divine spasm, this is also famous as the revelation of spanda or spanda shastras. These various nomenclatures of the Shaiva doctrines are according to various propounds and the main purport.

Pratyabhijna literally means a recollective cognition of a previously perceived object. Any recognition of an entity or person seen before at a different place after another perception in the form - this verily is the same person, this is definitely the same entity, I am the same ishwara (which has been propounded by the revelations or the guru). Such experiences are defined as pratyabhijna.

After the initiation by the preceptor and thus the removal of ignorance when the empirical soul recognises the purport of the notion “I am shiva” or experiences the ultimate truth as shiva, the realisation of shivahood follows then and there. This is the main purpose of this doctrine of pratyabhijna.

This book of thought pertains to monism and sage Durvasa is its first exponent, where as sage Tryambaka propagated this for the first time. Acharya Vasugupta compiled the elements of this doctrine. From a discursive viewpoint, shivsootras are the essential tenets of this doctrine. There is a folk lore that Lord Shiva confided in shivsootras to vasugupta in a dream. As per the tradition, the Lord ordained him to obtain these aphorisms as engraved on a slate on the mount Mahadev and propagate it. The rock is known as the boulder of shivaशिवोप.

These seventy seven aphorisms are the cardinal tenets of this Doctrine.

1. Eighth century spandakarika of vasugupta,
2. Ninth century shivdrishti of somanand,
3. Tenth century utpal devas pratyabhijna marina,
4. Spandradeepika,
5. Pratyabhijna vimarshini, paramarth, tantralok, of the ingeniously erudite scholars of various lores of literature, dance, dramaturgy and mysticism of the great Abhinavguptacharya.
6. Shiv sutra viarshini, pratyabhijna and spend nirnaya of khshemraja.
7. Parapraveshika, tava sandoha shiv stotravali spend sandoha of bhaskara and varadrāja.
8. Shiv sutra Vartika And paramarth vikriti of Yogiraj.

Are some of the main treatises on pratyabhijna doctrine.

The important topics discussed in these principal scriptures of pratyabhijna doctrine are the ultimate, the empirical soul, the universe, Maya or the delusive power of the lord, and emancipation. The position of these topics in this doctrine is discussed as follows. In the beginning the most important topic i.e. the absolute truth is pondered. The ultimate truth in this doctrine is the absolute Lord Shiva who is one without a second. In this very para Shiva is known by different names like Parameshwar, Chit para Samvit, Anuttara etc. Shiva is existence, consciousness, bliss, self luminous, and in the form of self evident gnosis. Lord Shiva has no other specific entity other than Him in this universe and beyond it. When he desires to expand he becomes twofold in the form of Shiv and Shakti. Shiva creates the universe with his Shakti called maya. Its only because of his Shakti that he is self evident, self luminous, independent and blissful. Owing to her virtue of being Shakti or power Shakti, the primordial causation becomes self evident and illuminates the self or *atma*. Both Shiva and Shakti are homogeneous and complimentary. Their union is the speciality of this school of thought. It has been said in Shiv drishti that there is unison of Shakti and the one to whom

the Shakti belongs. This Doctrine maintains that Shiva has five Shakti's, chit, anandshakti, ichchha, jnana and kriya (the powers of consciousness, bliss, will, gnosis and action respectively).

The votaries of pratyabhijna reject any notion of instrumental cause like a loom while making a piece of cloth or wheel rod and potter for making a pitcher etc. On the other hand Balkeshwar alone is the principle cause of this universe. Maya in pratyabhijna is differently defined from the sense in which a notary of Vedanta understands it. She accounts for the veiling of the ultimate Shiva by assuming five forms – *kala*, *vidya*, *rag*, *kala*, and *niyati*. These conditions his omniscience, self sufficiency, perpetually enlightened disposition, independence and uninterrupted gnostic nature. And hence, he is conditioned in the form of an empirical soul. The maya causes conditioning as follows:

Kalaa - omnipotence

Vidya - omniscience

Raga - complete fulfilment

Kala - unlimited doer-ship

Niyati - independence

The great Shakti of Shiva as per the spend shashtra (the theory of spasmodic consciousness) is in fact his creative flux only which is inseparable from him. This great Shakti or *mahamay* is the origin of maya. This delusive power of the lord causes incessant cycle of misgivings of an empirical soul.

Since pratyabhijna maintains that one parameshwara is the only elementary tatwam and nothing actually exists besides him - this doctrine is also known as *Ishvarite* or *shaivite* monism. There is no such thing called science or maya as different from ishvara but ishvara himself manifests in the form of maya. In the philosophy of *advaita* propounded by adishankara depicts the illusory nature of all other entities except Brahman. Shaiv advaita apparently looks similar but both different in as much as. Param Shiva is the only entity without a second, but this is not consistent since there is as great difference between the two schools of thought. Brahman is an attribute less, all conscious entity with no doership iswaradwaita vindicates the worship or omnipotence and omniscience of Shiva. Therefore, creation sustenance, annihilation, relinquishing/veiling and redemption are attributed to paramshiva. Pratyabhijna doctrine defines moksha as undoing the knot of science and recognition of ones shiva hood, pratyabhijna or an intuitive insight into ones shiva hood is the only means to salvation, the gnosis of the form

“That shiva is my essential nature” is the nature of pratyabhijna. The knot of science is meum and erroneous identification with the body etc. The oblivion of ones essential nature is removed through pratyabhijna which leads to emancipation. This is possible only when the knowledge of unison of jiva and ishvara dawns.

This doctrine does aim at kaivalya (isolation) but the ultimate goal is the attainment of Shiva or let's say shivahood .

Kaivalyam is the ultimate goal of Patanjali's yoga which is attained by the knowledge of prakriti and purusha. There is only chit or consciousness in this state but there is no power of consciousness or chitshakti. There is knowledge or Hanna but no doership. But if the ultimate objective is shivahood there is omniscience as well as omnipotence. Actually speaking both jnana and kriya are not dissimilar but one and the same thing, in the doctrine of pratyabhijna. This is worth noticing that just as jnana or knowledge is the only means of moksha in shankaras monism, just the knowledge of unison of jiva and shiva does not suffice in pratyabhijna. The knowledge of identity with shiva generates intense devotion this we find a very agreeable reconciliation of devotion and knowledge in this school of thought. The recognition of ones essential nature i.e. Shivahood is moksha. Anyone who has accomplished this is certainly liberated. Emancipation does not follow merely by rationally knowing the purport of the great dictum. Blishh and

consciousness (*chdanand*) can be had only by the munificence of Shiva of which guru is a personification. Emancipation can be had only as the guru's munificence or *anugrah*. A liberated soul does not acquire a divine body for going to the heavenly realms but seeks emancipation here and now even while living. Such adept are called *jeevanmukta* or liberated even as alive. A strong commitment of ones all conscious nature is *moksha*.

The absolute blissful and conscious essential nature is recognised and a subjective knowledge of the self-dawns only then an empirical soul is liberated from all bondage. This recognition of one's essential nature is *moksha* or emancipation .

(English rendering by Varni Paratparswarup)

4. We perceive-Think-ive only the past!

by Satya Nanda

Under the normal circumstances whatever we perceive from outside sources is just the past, be it by seeing, listening, smelling or just anything we encounter in day today life.

Whatever we visualise, an object or a person, it is because of the reflection of the light from its surface. As the speed of light is 299,792,458 meters per second, approximated as 300,000 kilometres per second. Distance of Sun from Earth is 1.496×10^8 km, therefore at the speed of light it is 8.317 min (499 sec) that means light takes 8.317 min to reach Earth's surface from the Sun. Reflected sunlight from the Moon's surface takes 1.2–1.3 seconds to travel the distance to the Earth's surface.

A light-year is the distance that light travels in a vacuum in one Julian year (exactly 365.25 days) which equals to just under 10 trillion kilometres and is used to measure the distance of stars, milky way etc.

When we see an object or a person, it is because of the reflection of the light from its surface, the light signals in the brain are analysed and we see the object. So, everything that we thus see is literally the past of that object, which means we are always looking at the past when we look outside.

If you look at distant stars, it takes light years, if you look at the moon, it takes few seconds, and if you look at the objects or person, it takes fractions of nanoseconds but the truth is whatever you have perceived was from the past.

Similarly, the speed of sound is 343 meters per second which is much less than the light speed and so it takes some time for the sound waves to reach your ear drum and later to be analysed and understood by you.

So actually we are seeing the past and listening the past through our physical eyes and ears and by the time we receive and our mind analyse the signals, things at the other end have changed; similarly the thoughts too, if we can read them!

So in the outside world we are interacting with the past but within it is ever new presence!

Therefore, whatever you see or perceive in the present moment is actually the past of it, as firstly it is just materialisation of one's previous thought e.g. if you see a building, today it is there and tomorrow it might not be there or replaced by something else; secondly e.g. if you look around and see anything or listen to anyone, the stimulus reaches you in fractions of nanoseconds and then interpreted by your mind and you feel as if you have perceived something, seen or listened to something. Light and sound travels at their speeds and it takes some time to reach you (as already mentioned above). So there is nothing known as Present everything which you are perceiving now has actually already happened in the past, might be a fraction of nanoseconds earlier. And by the time you perceive and interpret it, the things, atoms, particles (electrons etc), energies etc., at the other end have already changed their position, so you are not perceiving the real presence, it is just the past image of that. The only thing which is real is the fourth dimension of consciousness as per *Upnishads*, the Presence, the Turiyavastha!

It is said that God is eternally present. The day we perceive and become fully aware of the present both - within and without i.e. we start perceiving the self to be omnipresent, seeing the self everywhere in everything, that will be the moment of 'living in the present' and actually living the God's presence, in fact we will be God at that moment. But that state should be permanent. Lahiri Mahasaya has always stressed upon to be permanently fixed in that state of Para-avastha or Turiyavastha!

Think! Go Beyond Time and Space . . .

K

5. Pics and poems



Our Continuities

This rain that is here
not in Spanish plains
will wash the silver
sides of air borne sword
as it flies with me through
particles, eyes and time...

This rain here falling
on black roads shines
like silver reflectors
all that is above...we walking
in bubbles all covered
in raincoats and hats

This rain that makes
moments alive with wetness
infusions of sadness wonder
sweet joy a-coming
all fused into one ball
love's unwinding threads

See circles in the puddles
Here I am thinking through
innuendoes of notes words
emails poems always the gaze
gaze which caressed coating
my cells with finesse

This rain reminds me of
all those things that words

cannot define nor suggest
but that gaze that shines even
through puddles, and rain and sky
Time makes continuous...

completions are but continuities
there are no endings—even if
we wander far the nearness
brings us close as skin of dreams
This rain curls my hair
warm coffee swirls in a mug

[Prof Ambika Talwar teaches creative art in California

U.S. an Indian American poetess with a bent for eastern metaphysics. Most of her poems are inspired by
mystic insight]



6. WISDOM FROM SHIVAS RATTLED-RUM.

14th aphorism DECODING THE ULTIMATE WISDOM .

॥ हल् ॥ 14 ॥

तत्त्वातीतः परं साक्षी सर्वानुग्रहविग्रहः ।

अहमात्मा परो हल् स्यामिति शम्भुस्तिरोदधे

The embodiment of compassion and the witness that transcends all elementary constituents of the phenomena is the supreme self or the super ego which is denoted by हल् . "I am that said" shiva and disincarnated.

By tatwas either thirty six elementary constituents of the universal phenomena groups represent shiv, shakti, sadashiv, ishwarand shydhvidya. Dental consonants are the five conditioning sheaths. The 5 cerebral consonants – prakriti, mind, heart, reason and ego. Lingual cerebrals are the five senses. The five labials are the organs of action. Ya, ra, la, va along with three dentals aspirata and la and ksha are the five perception and the five elements are meant or the twenty five tatwas of the samkhya philosophy which are also the first twenty five tatwas of the former, have been signified. Without a transcendence in toto there cannot be a consistent cognition of the subjective awareness. This tatwatita or transcendent witnessing conscious alone

can be the redeeming aspect of Lord Shiva. A conditioned and contorted Shiva cannot be conceptualized as endowed with his anugrah shakti. This power of redeeming his chosen ones is not different from para vak which is considered as innately in unison with parameshwara. Abhinav Gupta maintains that the parameshwara are ever engaged in fivefold functions is basically and prominently a redeemer. All other four functions are meant for culminating into the fifth function i.e. *anugraha* or redemption.

There is an aphorism in the brahmsurra explaining how there can be no discrimination or partiality in ishvara. His munificence is universal. In the mid-seventies I was living in a cloister at Rishikesh as a meekish altar boy. Anand moyi mata, a lady saint of great renown had come over her devotees and aspirants who were putting in questions and she was answering them. There was no scholastic or discursive exuberance. Words came from her immaculate guileless enlightened mind. Why am I deprived of the munificent benevolence? Why this discrimination against me? Asked one humble devotee from the audience.

She replied ,the grace of the lor is showering like rain all over but if you keep your pot inverted it will never fill. Keep your pot upright and you can receive his benevolence. Nandikeshwar describes the lord as the personification of munificence - a universal redeemer, Sarvanugrah vigrah. In a strict metaphysical sense the only form of redemption admissible is the emancipation from all miseries and the attainment of one's essential nature i.e. Shivahood .

From the stand point of anugrah as the foremost function rest of the four functions are only conducive to it. In a modest verbiage, Lord Shiva creates, sustains and dissolves the universal phenomena only to facilitate redemption. The creation of Shiva according to some canons of tantrism is in the form of metaphysical wisdom or *vidyatmika* which is an expression of the lord's munificence for delivering those who are languishing in the dismal darkness in their own imagery or ignorance. A termination of this reciprocating and perpetuated trail of vikalpa or vikalpa kshaya is possible only through the power of redemption or *anugratmika shakti* of the lord. Kriya, ichha, jnan, chit and para are the names of the five shaktis. Para is held as supreme specially in a context such as this when the four offsprings of Brahma are supposed to be redeemed. After his routine dance of annihilation, Shiva plays his rattle drum fourteen times to enlighten adepts like sanaka etc. Modernists in the area of Sanskrit have demystified all schools of grammatical thought. Modern trends in Sanskrit education has very little or nothing to do with the ecclesiastical discipline of the yore which as it were, did imbibe some metaphysical and thus mystic element in it. An admixture of undue determinism has made grammar too exoteric and discursive. But traditionally these aphorisms have also been used for worshiping the icons of Shiva or exorcising ghosts and goblins i.e. besides decoding the aphorisms of panini.

One might as well explain the existence of hobgoblins and ghosts as a produce of ignorance that prevails before the knowledge of grammar and thus the wisdom of the revelations has dawned. And thus the utilitarian implication of these fourteen rattle drum beats as a witch doc's abracadabra. Such pious frauds are inevitable features of all cultures and dilettante rationalists need to understand this. According to the monism the supreme self is only the substratum and the universe is superimposed so the substratum in its essential nature doesn't pervade the phenomena. The pervasive nature is secondary and is usually referred to as antaryami or the one who controls from within. Both as the discursive theory of monism goes are not similar entities. The knowable and the adorable both are two different and dissimilar entities.

tadev brahm twam vidhi nedam yadidam upasate (ken upanisad)

Know that [as described above] to be brahma and not the one worshiped by the hoi polloi. This may not be easy for an aspirant badly conditioned in objective misidentification to assimilate or cogitate.

There are two types of vivratas (virtual modification without any change in the substratum) *murti vivrata* a figurative modification and *kruya vivrata* or a dynamic modification. Shiva as inseparable from his vimarsha shakti or para becomes gross to descend to the level of pashyanti vak. This phenomena of "becoming" is in fact modification or vivrata. When word and meaning have just begun to bifurcate like cotyledons in

a sprout, name and form become distinct. Shiva as a personified entity dancing and playing his rattle drum is a murti vivarta of the absolute transcendental principle. The power and process of his playing the hourglass drum is kriya vivarta or the dynamic modification. This dance followed by the fourteen beats of the dhakka emanating fourteen aphoristic encryptions, is a prelude to the raison d'être of revelation ability (obfunderkeit) through grammatical precision. Conservation, reflection, propagation, facilitation and dispelling of doubts as the commentator patanjali postulates are the five main objectives of grammar. The power or process of creation as explained by revelation is also definable straightaway by the instrument of grammar itself. The underlying streamline of consciousness interlaces these aphoristic encryptions just as they pervade the text of the revelations both originate from the same source i.e. the omniscient principle is the fourth function of Parameswara. This proceeds anugraha and follows dissolution. This is to distinguish him from all that is created, sustained and dissolved. Disincarnating is not comparable to the feat of a rope trick conjurer. This is a prelude to the assimilation of his absolute nature. Before the ultimate knowledge dawns this intermediate incarnation that serves the purpose of rejecting aberrant viewpoint of the aspirants is concealed. In the anecdote of the *talwakar upanishad*, all demigods try to investigate the nature of the mysterious yaksha. They couldn't and on the other hand their fortes like burning, drying, drenching, etc., were lost. Then went Indra, the King of Gods with all his regal gaiety and fervour, vane and indolent. The mysterious being did not even communicate with him and vanished into thin air. Thin air in this sense must be *chidakashbirv* the conscious ether, because the Upanishad goes on to say that in that very ether a beautiful lady incarnated she had a golden hue and adorned with gems and jewels.

The personification of vidya which we have already mentioned above is as the creation of Shiva only for the purpose of redemption. Sureswaracharya has devoted scores of verses in his magnum *opus bhasya vartikam* - vindicating the dictum that by the term vidya, the revelation refers to the mystic science of metaphysics specially culminating into the final dictum of the monistic experience.

The personification of upanishadic metaphysics is UMAHAIMVATI, the golden goddess. After the arcane wisdom had been communicated, she vanished and abided as the universal self which is also the essential nature of the aspirant.

Sanskrit etymology is so much conveying that almost an entire school of discursive metaphysics is etymologically oriented, they are called *nairuktikas*. Most of their votaries are grammarian purists who later converted to monism. From their perspective all words must be derived from some grammatical formation or other. So from a pure Sanskrit stand point, *bhu* is not merely ground or the earth. This comes from a root that means to come into being or to exist. This tradition has its roots in the vedas where go (or cow) is not some animal but refers to locomotion. This illustrious tradition has not only imparted indian mysticism an exclusive scholastic depth but also built as it were an intellectual firewall to safeguard against other defiant and deviant trends which invariably alloy the original purity of a holy doctrine.

Sham as some pratyabhijna scholar puts it, pertains to a total eradication of all miseries and the attainment of the ultimate bliss. The self luminous universal self arising from one such a mindset is *shambhu*. In the monistic school, if vedanta sham as sine qua non for the assimilation of pure subjective consciousness is well known. Shama means quietude, the other five being dama or control of the senses, uparati is focusing only on the primary objective i.e. emancipation, titksha is endurance, shraddha is faith, samadhan doubtlessness and mumuksa, an earnest desire for liberation.

Tirodhanam is also related with a divine agency called *tiraskarini*. She as the personification of a mystic phenomenon has been attributed to ishwara, the state of equal subjective as well objective awareness. Like all other projections of pure subjective consciousness she is also personified as a goddess. For the less competent aspirants her personified profile is somewhat like lady Godiva, a lady in the altogether on the horseback.

Her duty is to conceal the supreme wisdom from the incompetent dilators. This aspect of scholasticism was rigidly observed even by Plato. There is a heresy that any one who did not know maths and logic could not enter his academia. Knowledge should be concealed, the stoicists said lest the unworthy have access to it.

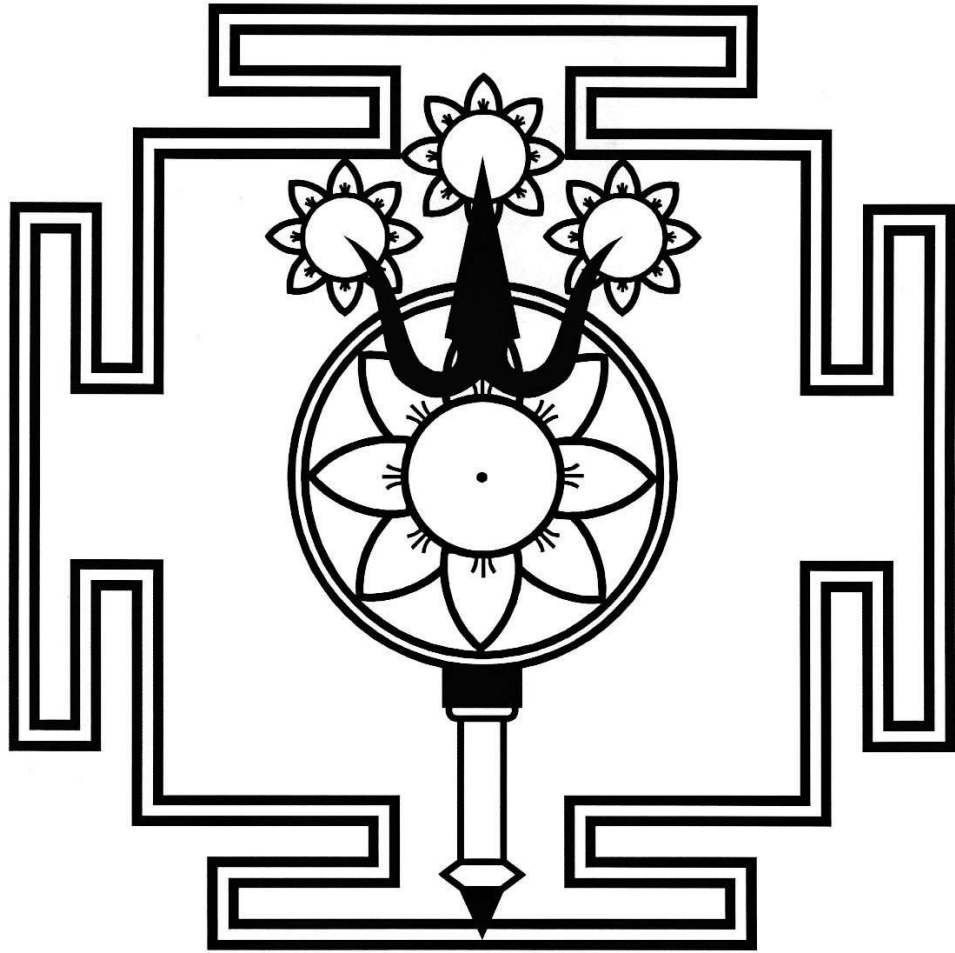
Tirodhanam is a mystic phenomenon in which either the source of knowledge gets obscure for the naive and uncultured, or the dilettantes lose interest in that particular area of knowledge.

And thus, Shambhu disincarnates according to some consequent aphorisms. The last letter 'la' is eliminated so beginning with the first vowel of the first aphorism and ending at the penultimate one i.e. 'ha', the Sanskrit subjective pronoun *aham* or myself, remains. There used to be a tradition of instructing the acolyte in the cult of *mounam* or *hasychasm* soon after he has received the commandment if the great dictum.

Toosneem bhav re tatwamasi. O shwetketu thou art that and now remain silent .

In the context of agamic tradition there is a command - *anachkamahalam dhyayet* after the subjective knowledge of one's own Shiva hood has dawned, there is nothing to describe or define. So one has to transcend all expressions by focusing on the wordless awareness of the eternal all pervasive silence. All pervasive because there are two notions of pervasiveness in the eastern thought spatial as well as with respect to time. Hence, the two terms akhand and nityam. These two words have no "ach" or "hal" i.e. all vowels and consonants are taken together. Needless to say that such lofty metaphysical expositions which culminate directly into the experience of one's universal nature, require a preceding of a considerable intellectual saturation and refinement specially that of the discursive dialectic. There are three methods of word transcendence in the oriental metaphysics; the vedic one, the way of a grammarian purist and the agamic or tantric method. The former requires a considerable ethical and moral perfection that follows a strenuous discipline under which the ritualist Vedic studies have to be undertaken. Purity as well ethical restraint that must accompany Vedic studies need a great level of purity of speech. All flaws in pronunciation during the Vedic recital have been listed as major transgresses by Hemadri, a noted essayist on the Hindu ethics in his famous work that enlists all Hindu sins. Likewise the meaning part of it is also ecclesiastically restricted. Arbitrary conceptualization of the meaning or purport of the Vedas is a great transgression. This explains why the Vedic lineage has been meticulously preserved and propagated under strict discipline of erudite masters. Major purposes the grammarians and for that matter these aphoristic encryptions serve is to allow as it were a direct or successive admission into the metaphysical core of the revelations. The grammarians method is that of the refinement of expression. Refinement being definable in terms of word and meaning unison.

To be continued.



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